



An official website of the United States government

**Official websites use .gov**

A **.gov** website belongs to an official government organization in the United States.

**Secure .gov websites use HTTPS**

A **lock** (  ) or **https://** means you've safely connected to the .gov website. Share sensitive information only on official, secure websites.

[En Español](#) [Contact Us](#) [Quick Links](#)

**U.S. Immigration  
and Customs  
Enforcement**

Call **1-866-DHS-2-ICE**[Report Crime](#)

ICE NEWSROOM

MARCH 6, 2026 • SCOTTSDALE, AZ • DETAINEE DEATH NOTIFICATIONS

## Criminal illegal alien in ICE custody passes away in Scottsdale, Arizona

**SCOTTSDALE, Ariz.** — Emanuel Cleeford Damas, a criminal illegal alien from Haiti currently facing criminal charges for assault and battery, died at **HonorHealth Scottsdale Osborn Medical Center John C. Lincoln Medical Center** while in ICE custody on March 2, 2026, at Scottsdale Osborn Medical Center in Scottsdale, Arizona. He was pronounced dead at 1:12 p.m. after becoming unresponsive. Despite lifesaving efforts by facility staff, Damas died. The **SOMC** physician reported the preliminary cause of death as unknown at this time.

The Boston Police Department arrested Damas for **assault and battery** Sept. 14, 2025 and ICE Boston arrested Damas without incident at the Boston Police Department Nashua Street Jail in Boston, Massachusetts the next day. Damas was placed into ICE custody pursuant to the Laken Riley Act, which mandates the detention of individuals with pending immigration cases who pose a risk to public safety.

Upon his detention, he was provided with a medical screening, where staff found no serious new medical issues but ensured he would keep receiving prescriptions for a preexisting medical condition.

On Sept. 26, 2025, ICE transferred Damas to the Florence Detention Center in Florence, Arizona, pending his immigration hearing. He was ordered removed by an Immigration

Judge on Jan. 6, 2026.

On Jan. 27, Damas filed an appeal with the Board of Immigration appeals, however Damas remained in ICE custody pursuant to the Laken Riley Act mandatory detention requirements mandating his continued detention as while the appeal was pending.

On Feb. 19, 2026, Damas reported shortness of breath and was immediately sent to the Florence Anthem Hospital to receive care. He was then transferred to the John C. Lincoln Medical Center Intensive Care Unit (ICU) in Phoenix, Arizona, for a higher level of care.

On Feb. 20, 2026, Damas remained in the ICU intubated on a ventilator with 50% oxygen at John C. Lincoln Medical Center. An ultrasound of his heart was completed along with many other tests that came back normal.

On Feb. 21, 2026, Damas remained in the ICU with no changes to his status. He remained on a ventilator with 50% oxygen. The medical liaison for ICE relayed the next-of-kin contact information to the case manager at the hospital. On that same date, hospital case manager notified Damas' next of kin.

On Feb. 22, 2026, Damas remained in the ICU on a ventilator. The oxygen was turned down to 40% and he remained critical but stable.

On Feb. 24, 2026, Damas remained in the ICU intubated and sedated on 55% oxygen per ventilator. The JLMC conducted an abdominal ultrasound with negative results. His ammonia, liver function tests, and white blood cell counts returned elevated.

On Feb. 22, 2026, The JLMC conducted Methicillin Resistant Staph Aureus (MRSA) testing and blood cultures. Damas continued to receive multiple IV antibiotics. The JLMC reported the likely diagnosis to be septic shock due to pneumonia.

On Feb. 25, 2026, Damas' MRSA results came back negative. Damas continued with multiple IV antibiotics.

On Feb. 25, 2026, the JLMC transferred Damas to the SOMC for a higher level of care and for a cardiothoracic workup. Before being transferred he had two chest tubes placed on his right side and a thoracentesis was completed to help remove excess fluid from the pleural spaces around the lungs.

On Feb. 26, 2026, Damas remained in the ICU at the SOMC intubated and sedated on a ventilator on 40% oxygen. On that same date, the SOMC scheduled Damas for a right video assisted thoracoscopic surgery (VATS) decortication procedure.

On Feb. 27, 2026, Damas remained at the SOMC in the ICU.

On Feb. 28, 2026, the medical liaison for ICE notified Damas' next-of-kin that they were permitted to visit him.

On March 1, 2026, Damas' next-of-kin and family members arrived at the SOMC and remained with him throughout the night while he remained under guard.

On March 2, 2026, Damas' health did not improve after the VATS procedure. Damas continued to be intubated and sedated on a ventilator.

On March 2, 2026, at 1:12 p.m. MST, a doctor at the SOMC, in Scottsdale, Arizona, pronounced Damas deceased. The SOMC physician reported the preliminary cause of death as unknown at this time.

ICE notified the Department of Homeland Security's Office of Inspector General, ICE's Office of Professional Responsibility and the consulate about the death, as required by agency policy.

ICE makes official notifications to Congress, nongovernmental organization stakeholders and the media upon official reports of in-custody alien deaths and posts news releases with relevant details on ICE's public website. You may access this information in [ICE.gov's Newsroom](#). Congressional requirements described in the DHS Appropriations Act of 2018 require ICE to publicize all reports regarding in-custody deaths within 90 days. You may access these reports on [ICE.gov's Detainee Death Reporting page](#).

ICE is committed to ensuring that all those in custody reside in safe, secure and humane environments. Comprehensive medical care is provided from the moment individuals arrive and throughout the entirety of their stay. All people in ICE custody receive medical, dental and mental health intake screenings within 12 hours of arriving at each detention facility; a full health assessment within 14 days of entering ICE custody or arrival at a facility; access to medical appointments; and 24-hour emergency care. At no time during detention is a detained alien denied emergency care.

MEDIA INQUIRIES

For media inquiries about ICE activities, operations or policies, contact ICE's Office of Public Affairs at [ICEMedia@ice.dhs.gov](mailto:ICEMedia@ice.dhs.gov).

About Us

Enforcement and Removal Operations

Homeland Security Investigations

Newsroom



U.S. Immigration  
and Customs  
Enforcement



[ICE Contact Center](#)

Report suspicious activity: 1-866-DHS-2-ICE



ICE.gov  
An official website of the [U.S. Department of Homeland Security](#)

- |                                |                                  |                                   |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <a href="#">About ICE</a>      | <a href="#">Archive</a>          | <a href="#">Inspector General</a> |
| <a href="#">Accessibility</a>  | <a href="#">No FEAR Act Data</a> | <a href="#">The White House</a>   |
| <a href="#">FOIA Requests</a>  | <a href="#">Site Links</a>       | <a href="#">DHS Components</a>    |
| <a href="#">Privacy Policy</a> | <a href="#">Performance</a>      | <a href="#">USA.gov</a>           |
| <a href="#">DHS.gov</a>        | <a href="#">Reports</a>          |                                   |

**NTAS**  
NATIONAL TERRORISM  
ADVISORY SYSTEM

**NO CURRENT  
ADVISORIES**